



Next-gen Witcher 3 for Q4 2022
CDPR announce a Q4 release for Witcher 3: Wild Hunt after previously targeting Q2.
<https://digit.in/jun22-23>



The Mandalorian S3 set for 2023
Third season of The Mandalorian is expected to release on February 2023, confirms Disney+.
<https://digit.in/jun22-24>



Origins of GIFs

The most commonly used small animation images and videos, GIFs are a nice way to make your chats more interesting and express your feelings.

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hile texting have you ever found yourself, sending Michael Scott's "NOOOOOOOOOOO" or sending Leonardo D'Caprio's "Thank You, Cheers" on your birthday wish messages? Those my friends, as we know, are called GIFs. Small animations, which we usually share to express feelings or actions.

With our instant messaging services allowing them and coming up with more and more GIFs, it is not so strange that we have adopted using them in our conversations. But

have you ever wondered how these amazing and small videos came into existence? Or who created these?

GIF, more formally known as Graphics Interchange Format a short, looping, moving images with or without text, turns 35 this year. On June 15, 1987, this beloved file extension was created by a team at CompuServe. Steve Wilhite along with his developers team, was finding a way to compress images with minimal memory loss. The solution they came up with was using a compression algorithm and combining it with image parameters. This would be used for sharing or exchanging images between computers. Hence, GIF was born.

Interesting fact to know here is that GIFs came four years before the advent of the World Wide Web. GIF in a way grew up with the internet and back then offered support for about 256 colors. Originally, GIFs were exclusively used for still images. Later on, the format was changed and what made them exceptional was a specific compression algorithm-Lempel, Ziv, Welch. The name comes from its three developers, Abraham Lempel, Jacob Ziv, and Terry Welch.

Now it worked in a way that would identify repeating patterns, simplified them, and resulted in no loss of data at all. The repetitive and looping videos seemed familiar to that of a flipbook. And maybe that contributed to the success of GIFs in its early days as a fledgling format.

HISTORY OF GIFS:

If we go back in time, say the 19th century, we can find similarities between GIFs and some of the devices of that time. GIFs can be considered as digital representations of the tools which were used back then. These tools include optical toys such as the Phenakistoscope (1832), Zoetrope (1834), and Praxinoscope (1877). These depicted the movement of hand drawn or painted figures and served as the most early representations of animation.